

ASSISTING THOSE IN DISTRESS

Always approach each interaction with authenticity and non-judgement. See resources on reverse side for referrals.

Call 911 if an individual poses an immediate danger to themselves or others.



May Look

Like



May Sound

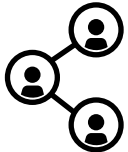
Like



What You
Can Do



What You
Can Say



Where To
Refer

Manageable Stress	Mild Distress	Moderate Distress	Acute Distress
Has a reasonable amount of stress and reports engaging in effective self-care strategies. "I've been pretty stressed, but finding time to exercise has made things feel more manageable."	Shows early signs of poor performance, inconsistent attendance to class/meetings, some difficulty managing tasks. "I'm just feeling a bit overwhelmed right now." or "I'm juggling a lot on my plate."	Shows signs such as continuous inability to complete tasks, inappropriate emotional responses, or poor communication. "I just can't do this. Could I have another extension?" or "I'm just struggling to get my work done."	Shows signs of complete withdrawal or hopelessness. Expresses direct threat to themselves and others. "I don't want to be here anymore, it's not worth it." or "Everyone would be better off without me."
Potential Action Steps			
Foster a supportive relationship with them. Ask about school or work-life balance & self-care practices. Post resources in your syllabi/in the workplace. "How have you been feeling lately?" or "How are you carving out time for yourself?" Provide general information about wellness resources such as Hokie Wellness workshops, support groups, or health coaching through TimelyCare.	Normalize challenges & validate. Ask about stressors and collaboratively identify helpful self-care practices. Document interaction. "That sounds difficult. What are some things you can do in the coming days to feel a sense of balance?" Connect to support & workshops that help build stress management skills through Hokie Wellness, TimelyCare, Cook Counseling (students), or EAP services (employees).	Ask clarifying questions. Use active listening skills to identify stressors and barriers. Affirm their strengths. Identify a realistic step together. Follow up. "I can see how hard you've been trying to manage it all." or "You said you've been struggling lately, tell me more about what's been going on. I want to help." For students, refer to Cook Counseling, Dean of Students, or TimelyCare. For employees, refer to EAP, TimelyCare or Hokie Wellness for resource navigation.	Calmly voice your care and concern. Know your limits. Do not guarantee confidentiality. Remain with them until they're connected to help. "I hear that you're hurting right now & I care about you. Getting help can feel scary; could we call a professional together to talk with someone?" For students, call Cook if willing to get support and Dean of Students if not. For employees, call EAP (if an option). 988 is also available for everyone. Be sure to communicate acute concerns.